



AUSTRALIAN
CLINICAL
ENTREPRENEUR
PROGRAM

AUSCEP IMPACT REPORT

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RESULTS, EXPERIENCES AND ACHIEVEMENTS
FROM OUR TWO-YEAR PILOT PROGRAM

Transforming the next generation of clinical innovators.

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FOREWORD



**DR AMANDEEP
HANSRA**

Program Director & Clinical Co-Lead

Designed to supercharge the next generation of clinician entrepreneurs in Australia, this two-year pilot was funded by MTPConnect's Researcher Exchange and Development within Industry (REDI) initiative and the State Governments of Victoria, Western Australia and New South Wales.

Cross-disciplinary partnerships have supported these efforts, with experts and mentors in technology, healthcare and business coming together to support the ideas and growth of clinical entrepreneurs.

We know clinicians are uniquely placed to fix the challenges facing healthcare today, but often lack the skills, mentorship and connections to innovate.

In the past two years, AUSCEP has provided needed education and opportunities to clinicians working in diverse sectors of healthcare. The continuing impact of their efforts spreads across digital health, biotechnology, virtual care, medical devices and much, much more.

Both cohorts are now complete!

46k patient lives impacted. \$32 million raised in grant funding. 138 new partnerships formed. We were able to achieve amazing results and an overall increase in capability, with significant improvement in Australian patients impacted by course innovations. This is because of the team's superb efforts and resulted in an above-industry standard net promoter score of **87**.

This success shows that providing clinicians with the essential foundations, industry know-how and a community boost can create a real impact at scale.

WHAT HAS BEEN ACHIEVED

Our first two cohorts have completed the inaugural program and are now well on their way to creating significant change in healthcare.

When AUSCEP began in 2022 there were few programs, if any, that were directed at clinicians seeking entrepreneurial advancement. As you can see, clinicians are a hard-working, intelligent, passionate and resilient group. Within the past 18 months we've already started to see great results.

TOTAL
29
NEW IP
REGISTRATIONS

TOTAL
46K
PATIENT LIVES
IMPACTED

TOTAL
138
NEW
PARTNERSHIPS
FORMED

TOTAL
\$32M
GRANT FUNDING

TOTAL
31
INTERNATIONAL
AGREEMENTS

TOTAL
\$1M+
REVENUE

THE HEARTBEAT OF AUSCEP

It's the people behind AUSCEP that ensure we deliver a world-class program. Meet our team of clinical and entrepreneurial all-stars.



Dr Amandeep Hansra
PROGRAM DIRECTOR



Dr Brandon Carp
ENTREPRENEURIAL LEAD



Prof. Kevin Pfleger
WA UNIVERSITY LEAD



Prof. Colin McLeod
VIC UNIVERSITY LEAD



Dr Carlo Bellini
CLINICAL CO-LEAD



Richard Macliver
PROGRAM DELIVERY LEAD



Dr Sarah Newby
COMMUNITY MANAGER



Oliver Bazzani
PROGRAM DESIGNER



Katerina Karanikolopoulos
VIC FACILITATOR



Peter Birch
NSW FACILITATOR



Claire Brown
OPERATIONS MANAGER

**FIND OUT MORE
ABOUT THE TEAM**

Even a dream team like this can't work alone. Our network of expert mentors and integral industry partners are critical to cultivating success for our entrepreneurs.



Hours of mentoring



Established clinical entrepreneur mentors and advisors



Industry partners

WHY IS CLINICIAN-LED INNOVATION IMPORTANT?

Healthcare services in Australia need to use technology, new services and creative thinking to solve the challenges that they're facing.

There is a massive workforce of clinicians in Australia who are capable of solving these problems and identifying new rising challenges. Their intimate understanding of patient interactions and deep knowledge of the everyday challenges of healthcare professionals has the potential to foster great innovation. They simply need a program that amplifies these strengths and gives them the skills to turn their ideas into action.

Clinicians are passionate about healthcare and want to feel empowered to solve the problems they identify. Feeling constrained by a lack of industry or commercial know-how, or becoming disheartened at their lack of impact can lead to clinician burnout and potentially see professionals abandon the industry completely.

Creatively fulfilled and engaged clinicians are reinvigorated in their career, especially when they see the impact their ideas can have, whether it's solving an acute problem or creating scalable change.

CREATIVE CLINICIANS CREATE SUCCESS

Clinicians typically aren't armed with the tools or connections to turn an idea into a commercialised solution. When coming into the program:

69% of surveyed clinicians felt they were not, or only slightly, connected to the healthcare innovation system.

37% of surveyed clinicians said they were not, or only slightly, aware of how to translate their ideas into impact.

However, clinicians are natural problem solvers, with finely honed critical problem-solving skills and a deep understanding of their field. AUSCEP helped bridge the gap between potential and reality.

CREATIVITY ATTRACTS AND RETAINS CLINICIANS

Seeing the same types of patients with the same issues, yet feeling like they're not solving the root issue can make clinicians feel stunted and ineffective. By providing them with an ability to fix the core problems, the entire clinician workforce is empowered, happier and more involved.

"I am so excited about where I am at, proud of the challenges I have navigated and the mindset and care I have taken along the way, as well as the risks I continue to take and I am excited to do my job again."

- Bronwyn Raykos, AUSCEP Cohort 1

"This program has been absolutely amazing and changed my life in the most positive way! My innovation journey enriches my clinical practice and vice versa."

- Emily Zhen, AUSCEP Cohort 2

THERE'S NEVER BEEN A BETTER TIME TO INVEST IN CLINICAL INNOVATION

COVID-19 sparked significant change in the healthcare industry. Inefficiencies and issues that clinicians already faced with Australian health systems became evident to the public, highlighting the need for investment in order to grow and adapt.

A greater desire for meaningful change combined with more opportunities and technology being made available to clinicians has created prime opportunities to invest in healthcare innovation.

WHAT'S DRIVING CLINICIAN INNOVATION?

Desire to scale impact in their careers

We are increasingly seeing clinicians who want to make an impact on healthcare beyond individual patient interactions. They're seeing growth in everyday technology and want to apply these solutions to healthcare.

Increased consumer expectations

Consumers are demanding more from the healthcare system. They're calling out negative experiences and have high expectations for their healthcare interactions.

State of the health system

Healthcare in Australia is beginning to reach a breaking point, and the solution isn't more staff. Instead, health services need to use technology, new services and creative thinking to solve the challenges that they're facing.

Increased availability of funding

\$440m was deployed into Australian healthtech companies in 2023, representing 16% of total startup deals. More funding is opening constantly, with \$1.7 billion available through the WA Government's Future Health Research Innovation Fund and \$2 billion through Breakthrough Victoria Fund.

Technological advancements

The rapid expansion of access to technology including AI and robotics has opened up new possibilities. The cost to develop innovations has come down, providing new opportunities for clinicians to enter the market.

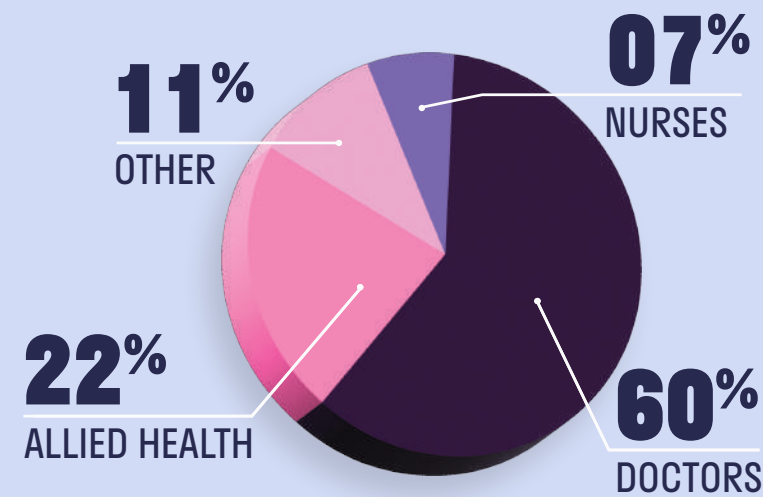
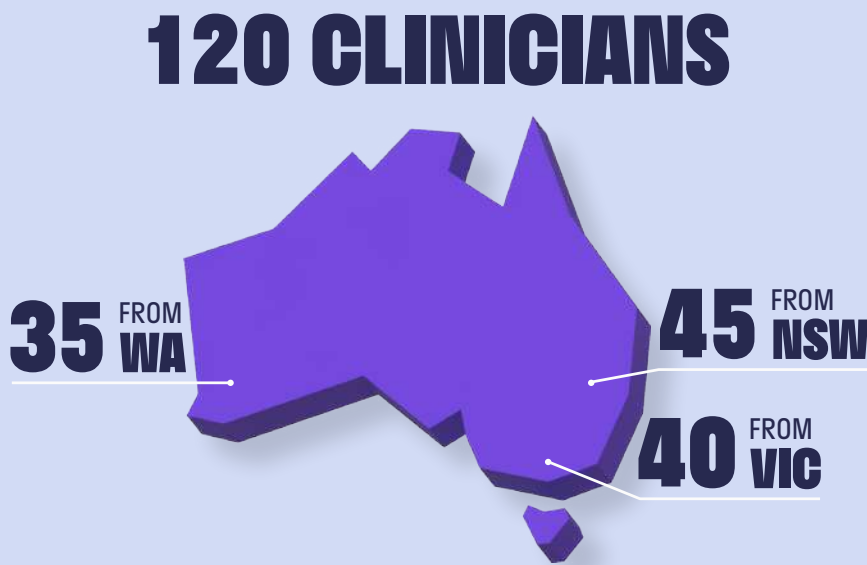
AUSCEP BRIDGES THE GAP BETWEEN CLINICIAN DESIRE AND REAL CHANGE

The current healthcare landscape isn't delivering on the demand from inspired clinicians and even the best ideas won't get off the ground without support.

Clinicians bring their passion, determination and understanding of the healthcare system to our program and in turn we provide them with the tools, mentorship and networks they need to create meaningful, lasting impact.

ANATOMY OF AN AUSCEP^{ER}

Brilliant ideas come from clinicians of all kinds and our first two AUSCEP cohorts were no exception:



25%
Intrapreneurship

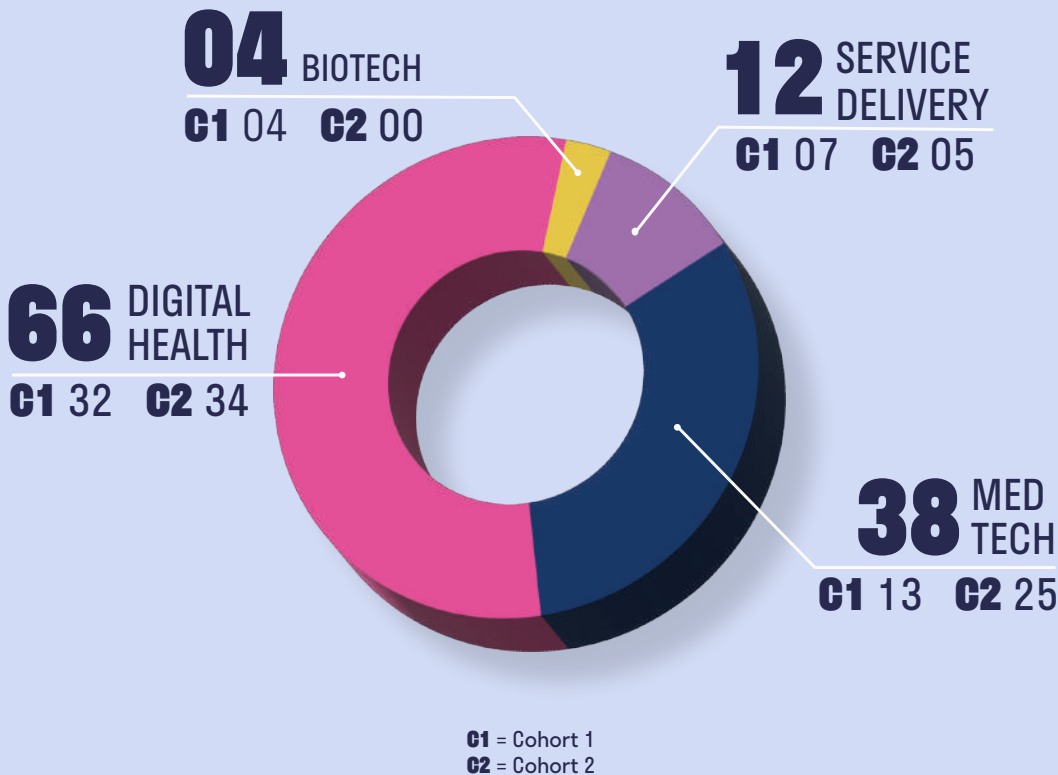
75%
Entrepreneurship

49%
Male

50%
Female

1%
Non-binary

OUR AUSCEP^{ERS} CAME INTO THE PROGRAM AT DIFFERENT STAGES OF THEIR INNOVATION JOURNEY



68
Participants with
registered companies

108
Pre-revenue
innovations

31
Companies with
existing funding



FEATURE DR BRANDON CARP

National Entrepreneurial Lead

“I believe that clinicians are uniquely placed to identify problems and see opportunities to improve healthcare through innovation.”

Dr Brandon Carp is a Melbourne based doctor, entrepreneur and the founder of Unified Healthcare Group. He’s one of a number of clinical entrepreneurs transforming healthcare.

AUSCEP marks a shift in focus, instead of clinicians pushing against systems and struggling alone, pathways towards innovation are being created for them. Brandon believes this needs to be pushed even further by looking toward the next generation of clinicians as they complete their studies.

Introducing the spirit of innovation and entrepreneurship even earlier through tertiary education means we are empowering future clinicians to use their ideas to shape the future of the industry.

The mounting pressures on the healthcare system provide enormous potential to revolutionise patient care and identify unmet clinical needs by those entering the industry.

As new technologies like AI and genomics hit the market, universities that work in partnership with health systems will be primed to harness the early opportunities.

The Australian Society for Medical Entrepreneurship and Innovation (ASME) was founded on the back of AUSCEP, with a vision for a future where medical entrepreneurship and innovation is considered mainstream for clinicians.

One of the key strategic priorities for ASME is to advocate for universities to drive innovation among students in their medical and health science schools.

Through programs like AUSCEP that empower active clinicians to become innovators and entrepreneurs and universities equipping students with the mindset to tackle future challenges, Brandon feels confident clinicians can better meet healthcare challenges before them.



FEATURE DR AMANDEEP HANSRA

Program Director & Clinical Co-Lead

Dr Amandeep Hansra is a leader in innovation in Australia, known for her work as a digital health consultant, entrepreneur and investor.

“Traditionally, clinicians have followed the established paths laid out for them by the industry, but this isn’t the only option.

Innovation thrives among communities. I founded Creative Careers in Medicine (CCIM) after identifying the need to create spaces for clinicians who were seeking non-conventional careers.

With a growing number of clinicians interested in innovation and entrepreneurship, my goal was to provide clinicians with professional freedom through access to experts, community, inspiration and support in their journey off the established path. Instead of feeling alone in their endeavours, they could engage with a community that fosters their entrepreneurial spirit.

Clinicians often work in their own bubbles, not realising the rich opportunities for connection and support out there. This mentality leads them to believing they are alone in their desire to innovate towards real change.

The same issues exist for many clinicians who have an interest in medical innovation and entrepreneurial endeavours: they’re unsure of where to go next. Without community, innovation and entrepreneurship can be an incredibly lonely path.

AUSCEP is creating a community of clinician innovators: a group of entrepreneurs finding professional development with like-minded people and experts. Here they’re able to share their wins and learn from the experiences and mistakes of others. Building these communities was an intentional focus of AUSCEP. We wanted clinicians to feel at home, with a tribe they could lean on.

Through events, programs, communities and groups, clinicians have found a community that supports their professional growth. We drove these connections further by connecting like-minded innovators, from individual mentor groups to Women of AUSCEP.

I’m proud of the thriving communities we’ve seen form of driven, passionate clinicians. This has been one of the most critical parts of the program that has had a lasting impact.”

“Being surrounded by amazing and inspiring people who are driving innovation and change in the most challenging of environments is life changing. We cannot be what we cannot see and knowing that there is a supportive community of people who have been there before gives you the confidence to continue, and that is essential to drive change within healthcare.” - Sarah Oorschot, Cohort 1

“Working with other clinicians and hearing their stories and watching the different journeys has been invaluable... I have made some lifelong friends.” - Whitney Luxford, Cohort 2

CHALLENGES

THE TOP FIVE CHALLENGES RAISED BY CLINICIANS WHEN JOINING AUSCEP

Stepping off the industry path comes with various challenges, many stemming from lack of awareness of the steps needed to develop their innovation into impact. Many clinicians are unaware of what is involved, or how to create their networks and find connections in this new space.



Raising funding

Many clinicians face barriers when trying to get funding. Unable to communicate their innovation and lacking the network, clinicians find they lack the skills to be able to obtain funding.



Networking & partnerships

Clinicians found that many of them live within their own clinical bubble, without the network and partnerships that could provide them with more avenues.



Product development

Clinicians are experts in the problem space but often lack the technical knowledge and know-how to build medical devices and digital health innovations.



Time management & work-life balance

Clinicians are incredibly busy and they have many roles. They lack the protected time to develop their innovation and make change.



Commercialisation

Individuals felt they lacked the knowledge on commercialising their academic research into more practical applications, and feared partnering with large corporations.

OPPORTUNITIES

TOP REQUESTS FOR HELP OVER TWO YEARS OF AUSCEP

AUSCEP is built on these challenges, providing clinicians the tools and strategies to tackle every hurdle. With a pre-existing network of entrepreneurs, innovators, partners and mentors, we were able to arm clinicians with skills through various means. We received over 500 requests for help within the two years of the program, these were the top five most common themes:



Product development

The clinicians sought technical and practical advice on how to build their innovation. We connected them with our amazing partners, DEPT®, Shadowboxer, WeGuide and Agenic, to teach them how to build.



Sales & marketing

Clinicians struggled with the concept of selling and marketing their innovation. AUSCEP provided them with practical mentoring from the team and mentors, dedicated pit stops and a branding and marketing 8 week course on how to sell and market their innovation.



Communication & pitching

Clinicians struggled to communicate their innovation or idea to a non-medical audience such as the general public, their boss or funders. We provided the clinicians with four week pitch coaching sessions, regular pitch practice and opportunities to showcase their innovation at large events.



Business management & operations

Many of the clinicians had minimal to no experience in running a business, or the complexities involved such as tax, leadership and accounting. AUSCEP utilised its extensive network of established entrepreneurs and partners to assist the clinicians to understand how to run a business and how to appropriately outsource.



Business models

How to make money in healthcare is complicated. Many of the clinicians sought advice on how their innovation could be financially sustainable. The AUSCEP team and mentors helped demystify the business models in healthcare and connected them with decision-makers and funders who could help them understand.



FEATURE DR CARLO BELLINI

Clinical Co-Lead

“We built AUSCEP for clinicians to deeply understand how to navigate the Australian healthcare landscape and successfully build projects and companies in it.”

For the past decade, Carlo has been engaged globally by healthcare executives and leaders who “want to deliver better care, cost-effectively, with superior patient outcomes.”

The goals of executives and clinicians are nearly identical. Yet most Australian hospitals and healthcare systems year-on-year have longer waitlists, are increasingly understaffed, with compounding inefficiency and cost overruns.

When building the curriculum, the AUSCEP team focussed on the predictable challenges clinician entrepreneurs face when innovating.

THEY IDENTIFIED FOUR KEY DEVELOPMENT AREAS:

1. Understand medicine and allied healthcare professions. Healthcare is a business.
2. Learn what it takes to build something - the blood, sweat, tears, time and capital.
3. Learn the mindset of a builder, how to navigate the ups and downs, and drive action, especially in bureaucratic healthcare systems.
4. Develop communication, pitching and sales skills.

The team crafted a robust mentorship structure with many adjacent offerings to achieve this from the outset, delivering one-on-ones, webinars and many guest mentor sessions.

Carlo delivered a series of masterclasses on customer acquisition, growth, marketing, how to thrive as a CEO/Founder, the entrepreneurial mindset, and live coaching.

These sessions taught clinicians that it’s nearly impossible to build and change systems unless you understand and align with the incentives of their key stakeholders.

This was a revelation for many who weren’t progressing with their work. The value they *thought* they were offering their potential customers was not actually perceived in the same way by their stakeholders. There simply wasn’t enough incentive for change and adoption of the product or service.

This turned frustration into insight. And insight turned into new strategies and productive action.

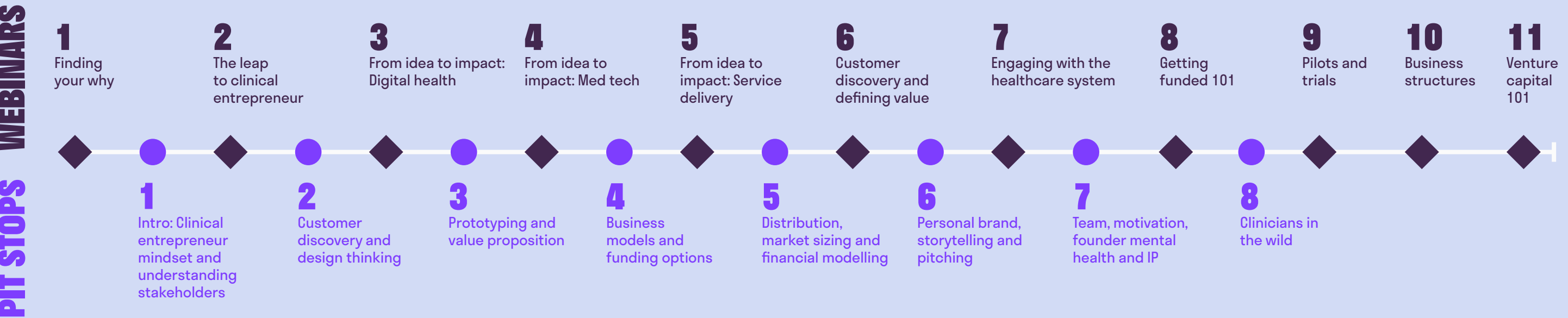
Clinicians learned how a bias to action over thinking and adopting an entrepreneurial mindset will help manage the emotional downs that all entrepreneurs will face from time to time.

By implementing this as entrepreneurs beyond a classroom empowered AUSCEP clinicians, they truly became the drivers in their entrepreneurial journey. Our exceptional AUSCEP Net Promoter Score demonstrates the program’s enormous impact.

Carlo is proud of the team and clinicians, who have come to see innovation and change as a journey. When more is understood about the game’s rules and how you can sometimes make your own, you see how to play it more effectively.

PROGRAM STRUCTURE

Our 12 month, part-time program transforms our clinicians from ambitious professionals with potential, into trailblazing entrepreneurs and intrapreneurs.



As well as regular webinars and pit stops, clinicians could engage in a wealth of valuable coaching, education and community activities, including:

BRANDING MINI COURSE

An eight-week speedrun to give practical skills on how to build a brand.

PITCH COACHING

Regular four-week courses on creating a pitch deck for investors and funders.

WOMEN OF AUSCEP COMMUNITY

A private community for women run by Sarah, Katerina and Amandeep with monthly talks from established women entrepreneurs.

MASTERCLASS SERIES

Small group sessions on topics such as scaling their business, mindset coaching and acquiring their first customers.

AI WORKSHOP

A practical session on how to use tools such as ChatGPT to enhance productivity and day-to-day operations.

ACCOUNTABILITY SQUADS

Small groups bringing like-minded clinicians together every six weeks to allow for questions and keep them on track.

COMMUNITY BUILDING EVENTS

Various networking events across the year that brought together clinicians from both cohorts, partners and mentors to build the community of AUSCEP.

SHOWCASE EVENTS

A virtual event where select clinicians could showcase their game-changing innovation to a wide variety of stakeholders.

INVESTOR FORUMS

Closed group sessions for clinicians to pitch their business to the most active health investors in Australia in an approachable environment.

CELEBRATING A NEW WAVE OF CLINICIAN INNOVATION

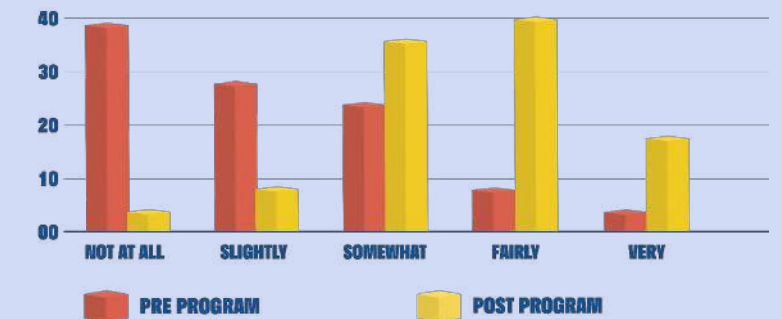
The priority for AUSCEP is to create the next generation of clinical entrepreneurs, capable of driving real impact across healthcare.

The combined results from both cohorts show the remarkable impact AUSCEP has had on clinicians involved in the program. They've gained practical skills and knowledge and built valuable connections in healthcare innovation, pushing their potential to implement change.

WORKFORCE DEVELOPMENT STATISTICS

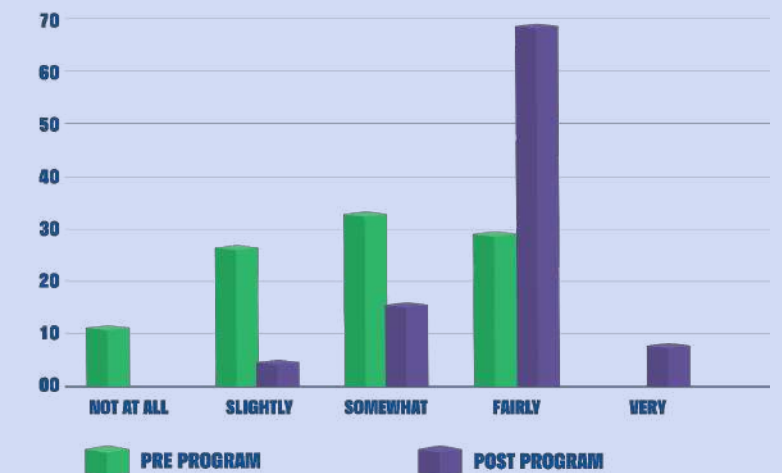
FAMILIARITY WITH HEALTHCARE COMMERCIALISATION PATHWAY

Clinicians demystified the process and increased their understanding of what's needed to commercialise their innovation.



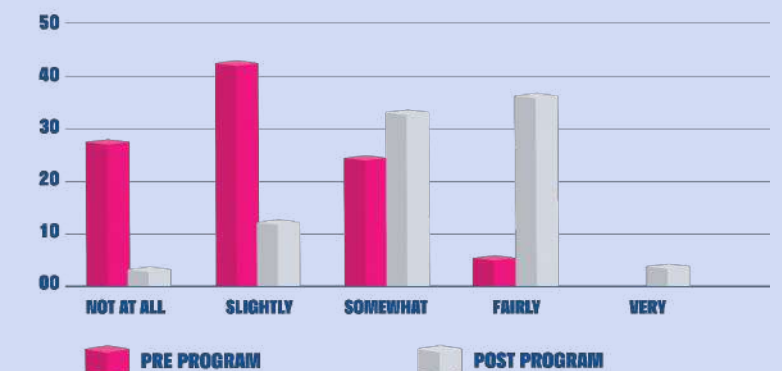
CONFIDENCE IN TRANSLATING IDEA INTO IMPACT

From individual clinicians with an idea, to empowered innovators with the skills, connection and knowledge needed to make an impact.



CONNECTION TO HEALTHCARE INNOVATION ECOSYSTEM IN AUSTRALIA

Clinicians went from their own clinical bubble to deeply connected in the healthcare innovation ecosystem in Australia.



PARTICIPANT CASE STUDY

BRINGING INNOVATIVE CAR T-CELL THERAPY TO AUSTRALIA



Collin Chin is a haematologist and clinician-researcher based in Western Australia. He's passionate about transforming care for patients with blood cancers, with a specific interest in cutting-edge immune effector cell therapies. These technologies use the body's own immune system to kill cancer cells and represent the latest era of cancer treatments, potentially curing patients with terminal cancers.

In Australia, the problem is twofold. Firstly, access is limited because the manufacturing centres are located on the other side of the world. It can take up to one and a half months for the cells to be manufactured and shipped back, which means that patients die before they get treatments. The cost is another issue, with the average cost of a single treatment being more than that of the average house in Western Australia - over \$700,000 AUD.

Collin's project aims to solve those problems with a local solution. Bringing this technology to Western Australia would solve the current issues by reducing time to treatment access by two-thirds, and reducing costs by at least 80% by manufacturing in-house. All this, plus the benefit of keeping jobs in Australia. A simple idea, with complex implementation.

When Collin discovered AUSCEP, he was intrigued by the ability to network and gain opportunities to grow what was a seed of an idea. At that point he didn't know what he wanted, where the money would come from, who to speak to or what the next steps were. But he realised that AUSCEP was a good lead and valued the recommendation.

In 12 months, Collin's perspective had been transformed by being a part of the program and he was surprised by the opportunities that came his way. He was able to use one-on-one mentorship from the program to develop skills on how to pitch ideas, how to write grants and how to network. Collin signed two partnership agreements and was awarded \$440k to expand his work in CAR T-cell therapy. This has provided the launchpad on which the opportunity for Australians to access this lifesaving treatment is growing.

"Through my participation in AUSCEP, I have learned not only how to advance my innovation project, but so much more. I have gained core skills including effective communication, how to navigate the Australian healthcare system as an entrepreneur, pitching to funding bodies/investors, forming new networks and thinking outside the box."

PARTICIPANT CASE STUDY

LEARNING TO NAVIGATE THE JOURNEY TO ENTREPRENEURSHIP



Jenny Kirschner is a pharmacist with experience across hospital, retail and corporate settings. She came to AUSCEP with strong passion and the very early stages of an idea. The journey through the program didn't lead to the flourishing innovation she expected, but instead redefined and focussed her path as an entrepreneur.

When AUSCEP was recommended to her by an entrepreneur friend, she applied with the intention of addressing loneliness in the pharmacy space, a problem she felt deeply committed to. Jenny found her tribe during the program, connecting with other clinician entrepreneurs. She also had to face the commercial reality of her idea.

"The program helped me put on a commercial lens, which I hadn't done before. I realised that being passionate about a solution wasn't enough. There could be many problems to solve, but without someone willing to pay for the solution, it wouldn't be sustainable."

This realisation was hard on Jenny, she faced a rollercoaster of emotions. Realising that her determination alone wasn't enough to make an idea successful, she ultimately stepped back from her original solution to look at the solution of loneliness in a new light.

Discovering that there is a lack of opportunities to commercialise in your area of interest can be disheartening and tough. However, reform in healthcare creates amazing opportunities for innovators as funding opens up. For example, as new funding became available towards women's health, those that understood the problem and had the connections were able to capitalise on those opportunities the fastest.

This is exactly what Jenny has done. When an opportunity arises in her area of interest, she has everything she needs to succeed.

AUSCEP armed Jenny with the knowledge she needed to assess ideas, and new pathways to take on her journey to successful innovation.

"When I have an idea now, I quickly experiment rather than invest too much time perfecting it before testing. Early on, I test assumptions, potential clients, and payers. This prevents investing time in the wrong direction. I'm still committed to addressing loneliness but engaging with it differently, in a systems approach. Some problems, like loneliness, require more of a movement than a product solution."

COHORT 2 TESTIMONIALS

AUSCEP works because it's run by successful entrepreneurs and innovators who believe in making a real change. They have hands-on experience building businesses, innovating within the health system, and have deep connections to the ecosystem. Real people solving real problems.

Here's what our Cohort 2 participants had to say:



"Running a business and trying to make change in health-care can be a very lonely and humbling experience. It's great to meet and get to know people who are trying to do the same thing. Plus often you just don't know where to start and whom you should meet. Having experienced mentors/facilitators saves so much time and effort."
- Errol Lim



"The community formed with like minded individuals has been invaluable, as were the connections with mentors that opened up opportunities and paved the way for collaboration and rapid business development. I would thoroughly recommend the program to anyone wanting to refine or expand an innovative idea or business."
- Jennifer Collier



"As someone who knew next to nothing about startups in healthcare in the past, the course consistently revealed useful information that I never knew would be relevant to my development. I look forward to applying what I have learnt from the AUSCEP program and using it as the basis of my future growth."
- Hanh Nguyen



"Amazing program led by an amazing team. The lessons I learnt have shaped my product more than I could ever imagine. The community I have met have inspired me."
- Anurag Ganugapativ



"AUSCEP is an incredible program offering an incredible opportunity. This program changed me as a person and allowed us to build a product with support and guidance."
- Patrick Gough



"AUSCEP has been a valuable program. It helped me understand entrepreneurship in a wide context. It gave me tools to problem solve in entrepreneurship and pivot when I needed to instead of potentially giving up. The instructors were fantastic, dedicated and caring."
- Ettie Ben-Shabat



"Being part of the AUSCEP program has been a huge source of support for me whilst navigating the stresses of the early stages of a startup."
- Chaturica Athukorala



"AUSCEP is a very well thought out program with exceptional and dedicated coordinators, with great content and structure to assist clinician entrepreneurs in their projects."
- Shu Ng



"I've been part of other commercialisation programs which have delivered great content. This program has affected me at a much deeper level in ways that put me in a much better position to progress my own innovation, but also to mentor and support the innovations of others."
- Robyn Sierla

PARTICIPANT CASE STUDY

BUILDING CONNECTIONS THAT SUPPORT SUCCESS

Craig Haifer is a gastroenterologist and clinician scientist researching the next generation microbial manipulation therapy. He found out about AUSCEP when he received an email from his Head of Department about the program. Having recently finished his PhD, he was aware of the huge research potential and the patient impact that it could have.



Having worked with various biologic companies in the past, Craig realised he would need to commercialise his work if he wanted his innovative research to reach patients. He recognised that there were three areas he needed to develop skills in: an understanding of commercial pathways, finding industry partners for development and distribution and how to secure funding.

It's common for PhD clinical innovators to struggle to communicate complex ideas in a way that's accessible for funders and decision makers to understand and support. Craig was no different. He took advantage of the opportunities given by AUSCEP and underwent extensive pitch coaching with Richard MacIver to hone these skills.

Attending AUSCEP pit stops helped develop a variety of insights on his industry. This perspective transformed how he wrote grant submissions and resulted in many successes. He found a tribe of like-minded people with their own resources and experiences to help in his journey. His AUSCEP mentor gave him the confidence to commercialise his product and broaden his understanding of all the avenues he could take with partnerships, finding various valuable connections in the process.

BEFORE THE PROGRAM, CRAIG HAD RESEARCH WITH THE POTENTIAL TO DISRUPT THE BIOTICS INDUSTRY BUT LACKED THE KNOWLEDGE ON HOW TO COMMERCIALISE HIS ACADEMIC RESEARCH INTO PRACTICE. BUT WITH AUSCEP HE ACHIEVED:

~\$1.8M IN UNDILUTED FUNDING

Advanced discussions with Heads of Research and Development at international biologics and nutraceutical companies

Advanced discussions with large manufacturing companies

An abundance of mentors to help him through his journey

THE FORCE BEHIND AUSCEP

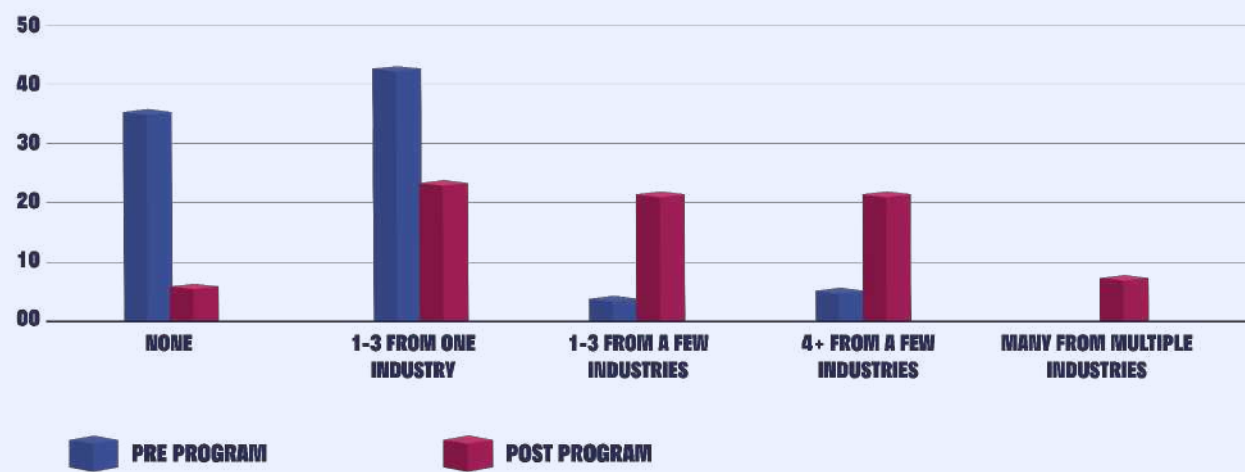
WE COULDN'T DO THIS ALONE

AUSCEP has formed a partnership network that includes Australia's leading clinical entrepreneurs, tech innovators and delivery partners.



MENTORS ENABLE CLINICIANS TO BECOME MORE CONNECTED WITH THE HEALTHCARE INNOVATION ECOSYSTEM

MENTOR OR ADVISOR CONNECTIONS FORMED DURING AUSCEP



“The access to mentoring and guidance has been one of the best things about the program, it has helped open doors for us and to start conversations with people we either couldn't access or we didn't know about.” - Amy Wallis, AUSCEP Cohort 2

OUR PARTNERS

All our partners, whether inside or outside healthcare, are driven by the aim to scale innovations that will improve the day-to-day lives of Australians.



















A NOTE FROM RICHARD

When we first started the design of the program, the sole intention was to create a program that would increase the number of healthcare companies that were clinician-led. Our curriculum was targeted at all aspects of running a business, how to get money, and how to develop a solution.

That was it. Provide the clinicians with education, mentoring, and connections to create businesses.

This all changed once we dove deeper into **what clinicians wanted.**

We found out they wanted so much more. They wanted a place to belong, a place to ask questions that couldn't be answered by books, connections to people that would have taken months to achieve, a place to vent their frustrations and share their successes, a place to learn from those before them that have built successful and failed businesses.

A place to belong and not be the odd one out.

And that is what we sought to create. We listened to their feedback, we heard their challenges and we designed a constantly changing program that was more than what we ever imagined. Clinicians are incredible and their potential to be change makers is only just starting to be realised.

It was an honour to be a part of their journey and help them unlock their endless potential, seeing their unwavering passion to help people and seeing their frustration in not being able to achieve their lofty goals.

We were able to clear some of those frustrations, by connecting them to the right person, educating them on how the health system "really" works, and helping them communicate to say what they want and get what they want.

We are only just scratching the surface on the potential of clinician entrepreneurs and innovators. **What's next is going to be amazing!**

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